

staff skills and pre-built applications that require it.

Q How can an existing MySQL user move to Postgres?

Because of its enterprise-class feature set, PostgreSQL is more like the larger, proprietary database solutions than MySQL, which has far less functionality. Most MySQL users would need to learn more about how to use a full-featured database management system like Postgres, and to unlearn some of the non-standard features of MySQL.

Q Is it easy for someone using a commercial solution like, say, Oracle or Microsoft SQL Server, to migrate to Postgres?

Yes, it is easy. Postgres follows the SQL standard very closely, and commercial databases have implemented SQL standard features over time. People migrate from those database solutions to Postgres every day.

However, administration of Postgres is different from those databases. This is the reason some training is recommended to perform the entire migration process.

Q Is EDB Postgres Advanced Server by EnterpriseDB distinct from the traditional version that is available as a free and open source solution?

Yes. EDB Postgres Advanced Server enhances the community Postgres with performance, security, manageability and developer capabilities to better meet the needs of enterprise users and EnterpriseDB customers.

Q Why would enterprises pick EnterpriseDB's EDB Postgres Advanced Server rather than any proprietary solution today?

EDB Postgres Advanced Server brings together the enhanced version of Postgres, compatibility for Oracle, and multiple tool suites for managing Postgres in a mission-critical, high availability architecture. EDB Postgres Advanced Server is the heart of the EDB Postgres Platform. EDB Postgres Advanced Server allows for the safe and efficient deployment of Postgres in enterprises.

Q What is the contribution of the open source community to the PostgreSQL project?

Postgres is completely developed by an open source community. Some community members are employed by companies that use, support or sell solutions based on Postgres, but they are community members first.

Q Where does India stand in the list of Postgres contributors?

India has many people employed by the Postgres-enabled companies. But we presently do not have many non-affiliated contributors to Postgres from India.

Q Does it help to have local communities of developers, or is it good enough to have just users?

We like to drive what we call an 'echo effect', where engineers get signals from multiple directions to deploy

Postgres. That does not happen if just the government says something or the industry says something. What we need is an ecosystem, where everything feeds on everything else. The idea of having a monthly meeting in a large city like New York, Mumbai or New Delhi is incredibly important because it tells the developer community that this is where the action is, and this is where the future jobs are going to be.

Having a user group is good, but we need developers, companies and the government to create the 'echo effect' and say that this is what you need today.

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Q What is the secret behind the Postgres community working together so efficiently?

To make your community happy to work for you, you need to maintain a culture of service.

There are mainly five to seven types of leaders. You can find a visionary leader like Steve Jobs, an institutional leader like Jack Welch, an inspiring leader like Oprah and a servant leader like John Willard Marriott. Each of this leadership type works in different industries. You probably do not need a servant leader in technology, because it does not have much human interaction and needs innovation. You, therefore, need to have a visionary leader. Similarly, in the service industry, you need a servant leader because, effectively, all the employees in this segment are servants to their customers.

Leaders need to train people according to their industry. People do not perform actions by accident. In fact, they are trained to envision, institute or serve the customers and are also trained in the necessary skills in a good manner. If you do not treat your employees well, they are not going to treat your customers well. This is like a one-on-one reaction. Organisations adopt this method of success. And, undoubtedly, this is vital to grow a community.

Everyone has some deficiencies, but when you interact with somebody and are able to bring out the best and minimise the deficiencies in that person, you succeed in a big way. This is what we consider as the Postgres community.

Q Do you see any difference in open source adoption in India now compared to when you visited the country first in 2007?

When I came to India for the first time in 2007, the only thing I did was go to the EnterpriseDB office. I do not think I went to any customers at that time. I do not even know if any Indian clients were using Postgres that year. I had spent a day alone in Mumbai and then I went to Pune the next day to meet the EnterpriseDB employees. That was just a two-three day trip, mainly targeted to begin my conversations